

Paper Plane

Anonymous Letters as Shared Urban Poetry

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GS Arts & Research Collective 2026–2027

► [Watch the demo](#) · [Portfolio](#)

(Live system & public archive in development — see Status below.)

Abstract

Paper Plane sits between a poetic game and a public digital archive. A user writes a short anonymous letter, folds it into a digital paper plane, and releases it into a virtual city; each flight returns an AI-generated ending, turning a private message into an anonymous urban story. The demo video documents the application, but it is not the work itself — the work is a lightweight ritual of writing, release, uncertainty, and return.

Research Question

Can an AI-mediated system carry human warmth without claiming machine consciousness? More precisely: how can a fragile, virtual object — a paper plane — become a medium for emotional transmission and narrative uncertainty?

Method / Form

The work is built as a system-design prototype that brings together interface design, AI-generated text, spatial movement, and archival logic. The paper plane operates as a media metaphor, fragile, directional, temporary, open to chance, while the city does double duty as the space the plane travels through and the archive it deposits into. (A GitHub release and public archive structure are planned for later versions.)

Argument / Contribution

Paper Plane proposes a form of AI–human interaction grounded in poetic exchange. It treats AI as a narrative mediator, a system that reframes human expression. In doing so, it asks how AI can help preserve emotional weight rather than flattening it into generic content.

The piece draws on a longer lineage of anonymous, circulated gestures — from mail art and Fluxus-style instruction-based exchanges to relational practices where the artwork is the

encounter rather than the object. Here, that encounter is mediated by a machine, and each generated ending becomes one fragment in a growing emotional archive.

What to Notice

Notice the moment a letter becomes a flying object, and a private sentence becomes a public one. Notice the city doing double duty as space and archive. The plane's fragility is the central metaphor: it carries feeling precisely because it can drift, miss, break, or arrive somewhere unexpected.

Prototype Note

In the current prototype, some 3D models and lighting are preloaded, which can increase browser load. Future versions will activate these assets more selectively through interaction. This limitation is part of the work's v0.1 status.

Status

Version 0.1 exhibition working paper. *Paper Plane* is part of an ongoing research-art practice.